

5.1 Introduction



The Web!

Since the beginning of third-generation systems, Internet has been an integral part of the computing experience. For many users today, the computer is nothing more than the Internet. One of the main reasons, though, for the rise of the Internet as *the* place to be has been a paradigm shift in our lifestyles, and the fact that e-commerce has become viable. While the technology that powers the Internet has essentially remained the same over this period of time, the distribution of information and the way it is looked at and used has changed dramatically.

In recent years, the availability of broadband has opened more avenues for the average computer user to make even more use of the medium. It is no longer restricted to being a place for leisure. It has also grown beyond the confines of being a place for a corporate presence. Today, everyone uses the Internet to retrieve information, find critical data, and even do research. In short, it has become *the* repository of information for the world, breaking geographic barriers as it simplifies communication across time zones.